

# HOUSE . . . . . No. 3678

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## The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

PRESENTED BY:

***Richard M. Haggerty***

*To the Honorable Senate and House of Representatives of the Commonwealth of Massachusetts in General Court assembled:*

The undersigned legislators and/or citizens respectfully petition for the adoption of the accompanying bill:

An Act relative to proper notification of deceased animals on state highways.

PETITION OF:

| NAME:                      | DISTRICT/ADDRESS:     | DATE ADDED:      |
|----------------------------|-----------------------|------------------|
| <i>Richard M. Haggerty</i> | <i>30th Middlesex</i> | <i>1/17/2025</i> |

# HOUSE . . . . . No. 3678

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By Representative Haggerty of Woburn, a petition (accompanied by bill, House, No. 3678) of Richard M. Haggerty relative to proper notification of deceased animals on state highways. Transportation.

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## The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

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In the One Hundred and Ninety-Fourth General Court  
(2025-2026)  
\_\_\_\_\_

An Act relative to proper notification of deceased animals on state highways.

*Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives in General Court assembled, and by the authority of the same, as follows:*

1           Chapter 140 is hereby further amended by striking out section 138a, as appearing in the  
2   2022 Official Edition, and inserting in place thereof the following section:- Section138a

3           a) If a Department of Transportation highway employee encounters a deceased dog or cat  
4   on a state highway while on official duty, and the animal has a tag, microchip, or any other form  
5   of identification, the employee shall:

6           (1) Attempt to contact the owner using the information provided on the identification.

7           (2) Notify the local animal control officer or police department, who shall attempt to  
8   notify the animal's owner.